



OHIO TRAIL NORTH SHORE FEASIBILITY STUDY

Steering Committee Meeting

Agenda – November 7, 2011

I. Project Schedule

- A. *Public Meetings/Open Houses – December 5th*

II. Key Person/Stakeholders Interviews

- A. *Preparation of List – Key Elected Officials from Each Municipality*
- B. *Municipal Survey*

III. Data

- A. *Background Reports, Studies, etc. (see list)*

IV. Discussion

- A. *Review of Current Alternatives*
- B. *Draft Project Vision and Project Goals*



OHIO RIVER NORTH SHORE TRAIL FEASIBILITY STUDY -

DRAFT VISION STATEMENT AND PROJECT GOALS – November 7, 2011

Project Vision: The Ohio River Trail will be a great asset and wonderful addition to the region. It offers important recreational, health, tourism, and economic benefits to local and regional residents. The trail will help to stimulate the development of new businesses as well as tourism-related opportunities like river rafting or canoe tours, bicycle sales and rentals, restaurants and lodging. It will become a highly desirable recreation destination, which will help to attract and retain businesses, residents (including young families) to the region.

Ohio River Trail Vision Statement: The communities of: Rochester Borough, Rochester Township, New Brighton Borough, Beaver Falls Borough, Fallston Borough, Bridgewater Borough, Vanport Township, Patterson Township, Brighton Township, Midland Borough, Industry Borough, Ohioville Borough and Beaver Borough will all be interconnected by a contiguous linear trail spine that links these communities with local and regional trail networks in an effort to support each community's initiatives to promote economic development, expand transportation options, provide additional recreation opportunities and enhance the overall quality-of-life for all residents.

Project Goals:

Goal #1: Establish the Spine- Establish a dedicated linear trail, paralleling and located as close to the Ohio River as possible, from the Monaca Rochester Bridge crossing to the Ohio State Line and north along the Beaver River to the nearest viable crossing of the Beaver River to the Ohio River. The location of the spine should consider the ability to serve feeder trails to connect the Ohio River North Shore Trail to other nearby trails and major parks and recreation destinations.

Goal#2: Maximize the Overall Potential Community, Transportation and Economic Impact-Design a trail in a manner that best serves the needs of regional users, businesses, employers, and property owners.

Goal #3: Make Physical Progress in Both the Short and Long Term -Determine the most viable route for a linear trail or network of trail segments that can be implemented within the shortest period of time and identify the preferred ultimate alignment, that can be created over time.

Goal #4: Develop a Bicycle and Pedestrian Friendly Culture throughout Each of the Communities - Identify a trail feeder system of on-street bicycle and pedestrian connectivity in order to maximize the ability of local residents to access the trail and the riverfront and also provide a means for regional users to reach local businesses, destinations and attractions.

Goal #5: Reconnect the Community to the River's Edge – Utilize the trail as an impetus for a regional greenway network of diverse publicly accessible lands, parks, recreation facilities and historic and cultural activity settings/sites along the Ohio River –i.e. make the Ohio River edge as publicly accessible as possible within each community and as a linear greenway network, while balancing the needs for preserving existing and future redevelopment.

MINUTES OF MEETING



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GARRIGAN
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PROJECT: City of Monaca, PA – Midland ORT North Shore

SGA PROJECT #: 11009

DATE: September 29, 2011

ATTENDING: Sean Garrigan, Nick Baran (SGA) and Chuck Jones (Mackin Engineering Co.)

Note: See attached sign-in sheet for list of steering committee and their contact info.

SUBJECT: North Shore Trail Feasibility Steering Committee Kickoff Meeting and Joint ORTC Board Meeting

A general introductory review of the project was held, focused mostly on schedule, logistics and general goals and objectives. Initial mapping was available for review and comment.

❖ General Comments

- CSX would like to transfer a parcel of land. However, hesitations exist regarding the acceptance of said parcel because it may contain unknown contaminants. This began a discussion regarding the liability of Ohio River Trail (ORT) Board Members with regard to accidents that may occur along any portion of the ORT. A vote was held and a movement passed to further investigate liability insurance options for the Board Members.
- It was mentioned that if the ORT North Shore Trail eventually crosses the border into Ohio and then proceeds into an Ohio State Forest, the Forestry service should welcome such a trail assuming it is constructed of a pervious material (i.e. crushed gravel).
- Mr. John Szatkiewicz of Ohioville Borough has started a butterfly preserve with a \$1,000 grant he received. The planting was carried out by Boy Scout volunteers.
- Mr. Nathan Peluso of the local cycling club mentioned that the club has "had some good rides." This was mentioned in reference to several weekend rail-trail rides that the club facilitates.
- The target date for completion of the new Veteran's Bridge that will cross the Beaver River is sometime in 2012. It has been fully planned and the construction documents are available for review. This bridge will eventually include sidewalks for pedestrians and bike lanes for cyclists. Doniele has these construction documents and can make them available.

❖ Key Issues

- The federal Transportation Bill is being revised for 2012. These pending revisions make funding that may become available currently unknown.
- A question was raised – What are the next steps for funding the South Shore Trail? **It is now closed out from DCNR and must use the ORTC to phase some of the total 6.2 million in cost.**

Next Steps & Post Meeting Action Item List

1. A committee should be comprised that would go after further funding for the projects. This should be a cross-county committee.
2. A steering committee should be comprised that would help facilitate contact with shoreline community members. Meetings should be held with these community members. 4pm was agreed upon as a time that could work best for these meetings.
3. Congressman Jason Altmire of the 4th Congressional District should be informed of the ORT South Shore and North Shore plans.
4. PENNDOT should be brought into these discussions.

Ohio River Trail North Shore Steering Committee List

Name	Representing	Email	Phone	Alternate	Email	Phone
1 Diane Kemp	Midland Borough	mrg@midlandboro.org				
2 John Szatkiewicz	Ohioville Borough	571bird@comcast.net	724-643-8427			
3 Sue Catanzarita	Industry Borough	scatanzarita@westernbeaver.org	724-643-3554			
4 Gary Craig	Glasgow Borough					
5 Alexander Andres	Beaver Borough					
6 Tex Smakosz	Fallston Borough					
7 Bill Rains	Bridgewater Borough					
8 Harold Harvey	Rochester Borough					
9 Larry Morely	New Brighton Borough					
10 Bryan Dehart	Brighton Township					
11 Mario Leone	Monaca Borough	manager@monaca-pa.net	724-775-9600			
12 Laura Rubino	BC Corporation for Economic Development	lrubino@beavercountypa.gov	724-728-8610			
13 Vincent Troia	Ohio River Trail Council	vtroia@troiaevr.net	724-774-8765	714-728-2626		
14 Doniele Andrus	Beaver County Planning	dandrus@beavercountypa.gov	724-968-0793			
15 John Van Jula	ORTC	J.E.VANJULA@yahoe.com	412-507-8754			
16 Linda McMillen	ORTC - Schiller	Cymc.miller@northland.in.net	724-378-6683			
17 Linda DeTee	ORTC OHIOVILLE	571bird@comcast.net	724-643-8427			
Advisory Member	Representing	Email	Phone	Alternate	Email	Phone
1	Beaver County Conservation District		724-378-1701			
2	Cyber School					
3	Penn Dot District 11					
4	Lincoln Park Performing Arts					
5	Midland School District					
6	Beaver School District					
7	Kinder Morgan					
8	First Energy					
9	YMCA					
10	New Brighton School District					
11	Monaca Volunteer Community Outreach	patricia.novak@comcast.net	724-715-3501			
NATHAN PELUSO	ORTC & Town Center Advisory	ngelusi@bushmill.com	412-874-3444			
Linda B. Halter		linda.halter@bushmill.com	724-513-4724			